

Boston Sunday Globe

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From the pulpit, a last word

A Boston pastor closes out decades of service amid great change



STORY BY TIANA WOODARD AND PAT GREENHOUSE | GLOBE STAFF
PHOTOS BY PAT GREENHOUSE

The Rev. Wesley A. Roberts reached toward his dense, crowded bookshelf and extracted a binder. With one flip, he found a description of his first sermon.

Date: August 1960.

Location: Clarksonville Baptist Church in Jamaica.

Title: “The Tongue.”

He pried a second binder from the walls. Hundreds more entries. From his time preaching in Canada, to Connecticut, to Massachusetts.

He stopped at sermon 2,635. Beneath it lay an empty space, reserved for his final sermon.

Roberts, 87, has delivered God’s word to Peoples Baptist Church of Boston for nearly half his life. The pastor has advised politicians through tumult, led the church through the rapid transformation of the South End, and consoled residents through life’s busiest moments. He compared his role to that of a father, who after years of rearing his family through good and bad

PASTOR, Page A18



At top, clergy members lay hands on the Rev. Wesley A. Roberts during his retirement celebration. Above, the children’s choir performed at the dinner in Klugh Hall.

Hundreds of green card holders prepared citizenship applications at the Reggie Lewis Track and Athletic Center with free help. **B1.**

The Boston University men’s hockey team lost in the NCAA championship game, falling to Western Michigan, 6-2, in St. Louis. **C1.**

The Red Sox rom-com, “Fever Pitch,” turns 20, and we take a look back at the movie and a baseball curse broken. **SundayArts, N1.**



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Suggested retail price
\$6.00

Wash and dry

Sunday: Rainy, drizzle.
High: 45-50. Low: 41-46.

Monday: Some sun.
High: 61-66. Low: 44-49.

Complete report, **B10.**
Deaths, **A20-24.**

Buy American? Choosing sides in a global trade war.

Our shopper finds it hard to purchase only domestic goods

By Janelle Nanos

GLOBE STAFF

The mission, should I choose to accept it, came from my editor last Thursday: Amid the trade war sparked by President Trump’s tariffs, could one bypass all the chaos by simply purchasing American-made products? Or is it so hard to do, and so much more expensive, that it would end up being even more stressful?

I nodded gamely. After covering retail for the better part of a decade, I knew exactly how this would play out: not well. But always up for a challenge, I took it upon myself to map out a game

plan to buy domestically over the course of several days. I even roped my kids into the assignment: *We’re going shopping and looking at labels for where things come from! Won’t it be fun?*

But mere seconds after arriving at my local Stop & Shop, the implausibility of my mission became clear — in the form of bananas. Bananas are a non-negotiable in my household — my 6-year-old eats one every night before bedtime, like the monkey-child she is. When she ran to the tower of yellow fruit and tossed a bunch in the basket, the potassium-minded mother in me caved.

So I took the opportunity to introduce her to the wonders of the global supply chain. The store’s banana display had Chiquita stickers from three countries: Guatemala, Honduras, and

AMERICAN, Page A15

In China, Trump has formidable opponent

Conditioned to hardship, Xi Jinping may sense his adversary has a pain point

By Li Yuan

NEW YORK TIMES

President Trump didn’t seem to mind as his worldwide tariffs set off stock market sell-offs and wiped out trillions of dollars in wealth.

“Be cool,” he told Americans.

Then he blinked Wednesday afternoon in the face of financial turmoil — particularly, a rapid rise in government bond yields that could shake the dominant position of the dollar and the foundation of the US economy. And late Friday, Trump exempted smartphones, computers, chips, and other electronics from some of his tariffs on China.

By pausing some tariffs for dozens of countries for 90 days and exempting electronics from some tariffs, he also gave away something to his main rival, Chinese leader Xi Jinping, with whom he has engaged in a game of chicken that risks decoupling the world’s two biggest economies and turning the global economic order upside down.

Xi learned that his adversary has a pain point.

As reckless and ruthless as Trump may seem to some parts of the world, in Xi and China, he is squaring off with a leader and a party state that have a long history of single-minded pursuit of policies, even when they resulted in economic and human catastrophe.

CHINA, Page A14

A torment for Biden coming for Trump?

President risks triggering inflation despite how it helped undo Democrats

By Jim Puzzanghera

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Inflation was picking up in mid-2021 as the world emerged from COVID and hundreds of billions of dollars in federal pandemic aid had started flowing, but President Joe Biden assured Americans the price increases were just a speedbump on the road to a stronger economy.

“Some folks have raised worries that this could be a sign of persistent inflation. But that’s not our view,” Biden told reporters. “Our experts believe and the data shows that most of the price increases we’ve seen are ... expected to be temporary.”

But Biden turned out to be wrong and it’s widely believed inflation cost the Democrats the White House last year. Now, just as the Federal Reserve has wrestled inflation back down close to normal, President Trump could be making the same political mistake with his sweeping new tariffs, in which he argues any short-term pain is worth the long-term benefit of forcing more manufacturers to produce goods in the United States.

“There’ll be a transition cost and transition problems,” Trump said Thursday, “but in the end, it’s going to be ... a beautiful thing.”

INFLATION, Page A16

-\$4,689

Estimated decline in real income per household from all tariffs*

SOURCE: The Budget Lab at Yale University

*Based on tariffs as of Thursday. Does not account for exemptions to consumer electronics from China released late Friday.

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*Annual Percentage Yield (APY) is accurate as of 4/11/2025. Offer is subject to change at any time. Fees may reduce earnings. A penalty may be imposed for early withdrawal. Certificates of Deposit will be renewed at standard Personal Account CD or Business Account CD rates at maturity, unless the depositor instructs the Bank otherwise. Consumer customers: Please refer to the Personal Deposit Account Agreement for details. Business customers: Please refer to the Business Deposit Account Agreement for details. Member FDIC.